Special Representative), Mr Wang Yi, over the Doklam issue, I suggested that this latest provocation at PP-14 could also be brought up. However, at that point in time, the situation emerging in Doklam was the graver, and the face-off at PP-14 was a mere blip on the radar screen. Little could we have imagined then how this nondescript PP in the Galwan Valley would galvanize an entire nation.

Back to Doklam. I had carried folders containing maps and sketches of the area. Using these, I carried out a review of the situation, culminating with the fact that a stated 'Red Line' had been breached. Since this had been part of my brief as Army Commander, Eastern Command, I could quickly and simply state the developments and their implications. It was evident to all that since this area lay within Bhutan, we had to follow it up with the Royal Government of Bhutan, particularly with His Majesty, K4. This had been precisely one of the scenarios that had been discussed during our meeting in January. As part of the deliberations, I suggested that we could carry out some joint training on the Southern slopes of the Jampheri Ridge so that we would always have some troops at hand for a rapid response. The Foreign Minister opined that while it was a good idea, the proposed area fell within the area disputed between Bhutan and China and that such moves could be seen as provocative. I reiterated that we had been doing joint training in this very area till the late 1980s. At the end of the deliberations, it was felt that as a first step, we could recommend to the RBA to lodge a formal protest with the PLA.

The next morning, it being a holiday, I was having a leisurely breakfast when the Foreign Minister called. He informed me that on returning to his office, he had rechecked the records and that, in fact, the area I had suggested for the joint training was not disputed. I thought that it was very honourable of him

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